

Senior Software Development Engineer in Test (SDET) – Backend / API

Summary

We are seeking a Senior SDET to lead and elevate quality across backend systems and API-driven workflows at Cast & Crew.

This role is focused on building scalable, automation-first testing strategies across REST and GraphQL APIs, with a strong emphasis on integration validation, contract testing, and data integrity.

You will work across multiple interconnected platforms, validating complex integrations that power payroll, onboarding, and financial systems. This role requires a strong engineering mindset, deep troubleshooting skills, and the ability to bring clarity to ambiguous requirements.

This is a hands-on role for someone who enjoys breaking systems, validating integrations, and ensuring reliability across distributed services.

Primary Responsibilities

- Partner with engineering and product teams to define clear acceptance criteria and test strategies for backend services and APIs
- Design, build, and maintain API automation frameworks for REST and GraphQL services
- Develop and implement contract testing strategies to validate service-to-service integrations
- Validate end-to-end workflows across multiple systems and APIs
- Create and maintain automated tests for complex business logic and backend workflows
- Perform data validation using SQL to ensure integrity across systems
- Integrate automated tests into CI/CD pipelines to ensure fast, reliable feedback
- Collaborate with developers to improve testability, observability, and system reliability
- Troubleshoot issues across API and integration layers, identifying root causes quickly
- Participate in code reviews and architecture discussions to ensure scalable test design
- Mentor engineers and QA team members on backend testing best practices
- Ensure traceability between requirements, test coverage, and defects
- Support compliance, audit readiness, and data validation standards

Required Technical Skills

- 6+ years of Software Quality Engineering experience
- 3+ years of experience testing backend systems and APIs
- Strong programming experience (typically 6+ years) in TypeScript or equivalent languages (JavaScript, Python, Java)
- Strong experience testing REST and/or GraphQL APIs
- Experience building and maintaining API automation frameworks
- Solid understanding of contract testing OR service integration validation
- Strong SQL skills for querying and validating data
- Experience integrating automated tests into CI/CD pipelines (GitHub Actions, Jenkins, etc.)
- Strong understanding of microservices architecture and system integrations

Core Competencies

- Strong communication skills – able to clearly articulate issues across engineering, product, and business teams
- Ability to take ambiguous requirements and translate them into clear, testable scenarios
- Strong troubleshooting and root cause analysis skills across APIs and integrations
- Comfortable working independently or collaboratively in fast-paced environments
- Hands-on mindset – enjoys breaking systems and uncovering edge cases
- Strong ownership mentality with a focus on quality outcomes and system reliability

Preferred Experience

- Experience with event-driven architectures (Kafka or similar messaging systems)
- Experience testing asynchronous workflows and message validation
- Familiarity with test reporting, dashboards, and quality metrics (DORA, defect escape rate, coverage)
- Experience working in regulated environments (financial systems, payroll, compliance-heavy domains)
- Experience with test management and traceability tools

What Success Looks Like

- High-confidence backend releases with strong API and integration coverage
- Reduced integration-related defects and production incidents
- Strong contract validation across services, reducing integration failures
- Faster feedback loops through CI/CD-integrated API testing
- Increased visibility into system health and integration risks

Why This Role Matters

Cast & Crew operates across multiple interconnected systems that power critical financial and payroll workflows. Quality at the API and integration layer is essential.

This role is key to ensuring that services integrate reliably and behave as expected at scale. You will help build the foundation for modern quality engineering across backend systems—where automation and contract testing drive confidence in every release.